

Timeline and Sources of History

1. History

- History is the study of the human past.
 - It helps us understand the present by learning about past events and societies.
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2. Experts Who Study the Past

Geologists

- Study Earth's physical features such as rocks, soil, mountains, rivers, and oceans.

Palaeontologists

- Study fossils of ancient plants, animals, and humans.

Anthropologists

- Study human societies and cultures from ancient times to the present.

Archaeologists

- Study the past through excavations.
 - Examine tools, pottery, bones, ornaments, houses, and other remains.
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3. Measurement of Time in History

Common Era (CE)

- Years counted after the traditional birth year of Jesus Christ.
- Example: 1947 CE (India's Independence).

Before Common Era (BCE)

- Years before the traditional birth year of Jesus Christ.
- Example: 560 BCE (approximate birth year of Buddha).

Important Fact

- There is no Year Zero.
- To calculate years between BCE and CE:

- Add the two years and subtract 1.

4. Timeline

- A timeline shows events in chronological order.
- Helps understand the sequence of historical events.

Important Events

Event	Approximate Date
First Humans (Homo sapiens)	300,000 years ago
First Rock Art	40,000 BCE
End of Ice Age	10,000 BCE
Beginning of Agriculture	10,000 BCE
Pottery Technology	6000 BCE
First Cities in Mesopotamia	4000 BCE
Indus-Sarasvatī Civilisation	2600–1900 BCE
Birth of Buddha	560 BCE
Ashoka	250 BCE
Birth of Jesus	1 CE

5. Units of Historical Time

Year

- Basic unit of time.

Decade

- Period of 10 years.

Century

- Period of 100 years.
- Example:
 - 21st Century = 2001–2100 CE.

Millennium

- **Period of 1000 years.**
 - **Example:**
 - **3rd Millennium CE = 2001–3000 CE.**
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6. Calendars

Gregorian Calendar

- **Most widely used calendar today.**
- **Has:**
 - **12 months**
 - **365 days**
 - **Leap year every 4 years.**

Indian Calendars

- **Based on the positions of the Sun and Moon.**
 - **Pañchānga provides:**
 - **Festival dates**
 - **Sunrise and sunset timings**
 - **Eclipses**
 - **Weather predictions**
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7. Sources of History

Meaning

A source of history is any object, person, text, or place that provides information about the past.

A. Archaeological Sources

- **Tools**
- **Pottery**
- **Coins**
- **Monuments**
- **Buildings**
- **Bones**

- **Burial sites**

B. Literary Sources

- **Vedas**
- **Itihasas**
- **Poems**
- **Plays**
- **Historical texts**
- **Travel accounts**

C. Inscriptions

- **Writings engraved on stone, metal, or other materials.**

D. Oral Sources

- **Folktales**
- **Songs**
- **Traditions passed orally.**

E. Artistic Sources

- **Paintings**
- **Sculptures**
- **Carvings**

8. People Who Help Reconstruct History

- **Historians**
- **Archaeologists**
- **Epigraphists (study inscriptions)**
- **Anthropologists**
- **Language experts**
- **Scientists (climate, chemistry, genetics)**

9. Early Humans

Homo sapiens

- Modern humans appeared about 300,000 years ago.

Lifestyle

- Lived in groups (bands).
 - Hunters and gatherers.
 - Used caves and rock shelters.
 - Used fire.
 - Made stone tools.
 - Created rock paintings.
 - Made ornaments from stones, shells, and animal teeth.
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10. Ice Age

- A period when much of Earth was covered with ice.
- Last Ice Age lasted from over 100,000 years ago to about 12,000 years ago.

Effects

- Climate later became warmer.
 - Better living conditions developed.
 - Humans began settling permanently.
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11. Beginning of Agriculture

Around 10,000 BCE

Humans:

- Started growing crops.
- Domesticated animals such as cattle and goats.
- Settled near rivers due to fertile soil and water supply.

Results

- Population increased.
 - Villages developed.
 - Food production improved.
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12. Growth of Villages and Technology

Community Life

- **Led by chiefs or leaders.**
- **Land often used collectively.**

New Developments

- **Pottery making**
- **Trade between villages**
- **Copper tools**
- **Later, iron tools**
- **Growth of hamlets into villages and towns**